

Acetaminophen

(Tylenol, FeverAll, Anacin, Vicks 44)

I. Classification – Analgesic, Antipyretic**II. Action(s)**

- Centrally Acting
- Exact mechanism unknown

III. Indication(s)

- Fever
- Mild – Moderate pain

IV. Contraindications

- Known Hypersensitivity
- Max dose < 4hrs prior (see notes)

V. Precautions

- Caution in liver failure or chronic alcohol use/abuse
- Multiple formulations exist. Concentration varies with manufacturer and trade names.

VI. Drug interactions

- Ethanol – May increase risk of hepatic toxicity
- Benzodiazepines - May increase risk of hepatic toxicity

VII. Adult Dosing and Administration

- 975-1000mg q 6hrs
- Dosing for adults is 1000 mg PO / IV

VIII. Pediatric Dosing and Administration

- 15 mg/kg PO q 4hs
- Max dose 1000 mg

IX. Onset

- 30-60min

X. Duration

- 3-4hrs

XI. Possible Adverse Effects

- Hepatic Toxicity
- Acute renal tubular necrosis
- Allergic reaction / Anaphylaxis

XII. Other Notes

- Many OTC medications contain varied formulations
- Overdoses of acetaminophen may be life-threatening!
- Overdose antidote = “Acetadote” (acetylcysteine, Mucomyst) – must be given with 4 hours of toxic ingestion
- NOT an NSAID. No direct interaction with ibuprofen, aspirin, or anticoagulants.